



Automating Configuration of InterSystems IRIS with Configuration Merge

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Introduction to Configuration Merge

This page explains the configuration merge feature of InterSystems IRIS® data platform, what types of operations configuration merge can perform, and its primary use cases.

1.1 Configuration Merge

The configuration merge feature lets you make as many changes as you wish to the configuration of any InterSystems IRIS instance in a single operation. To use it, you simply record the changes you want to make in a declarative configuration merge file and apply that file to the instance, when it is deployed or at any later point. Configuration merge can easily be used to automatically deploy multiple instances with varying configurations from the same container image or kit, as well as to simultaneously reconfigure multiple running instances, enabling automated reconfiguration of clusters or other multi-instance deployments. Configuration merge can be used in deployment of any InterSystems IRIS instance, containerized or locally installed, on any supported UNIX® or Linux platform, including Linux cloud nodes. You can reconfigure running instances using configuration merge on both UNIX/Linux and Windows platforms.

For examples of configuration merge files used to deploy containers, see [Deploying an InterSystems IRIS Container with a Merge File](#). The [Configuration Parameter File Reference](#) contains a comprehensive description of all InterSystems IRIS configuration parameters.

1.2 InterSystems IRIS Configuration

The configuration of an InterSystems IRIS instance is determined by a file in its installation directory named `iris.cpf`, which contains configuration parameters as name/value pairs. Every time the instance starts, including for the first time after it is deployed, it reads this *configuration parameter file*, or CPF, to obtain the values for these settings. This allows you to reconfigure an instance at any time by modifying its CPF and then restarting it.

For example, the `globals` setting in the `[config]` section of the CPF determines the size of the instance's database cache. The setting in the CPF of a newly installed instance specifies an initial cache size equal to 25% of total system memory, which is not intended for production use. To change the size of the database cache, you can open the instance's CPF in any text editor and specify the desired cache size as the value of `globals`, then restart the instance. Most parameters can be changed using other methods; for example, you can also modify the value of `globals` [using the Management Portal](#) or using the methods in the persistent class `Config.config`. Updating an instance's CPF, however, is the only general mechanism that lets you make multiple configuration changes to an instance in a single operation and automate the simultaneous configuration of multiple instances.

For an overview of the use and contents of the CPF, see the [Configuration Parameter File Reference](#).

1.3 Configuration Merge File

A *configuration merge file* is a partial CPF that contains any desired subset of InterSystems IRIS configuration parameters and values or an [\[Actions\]](#) section or both. When a merge file is applied to an instance with configuration merge, there are two types of operations that can occur. The first type is updating settings in the instance's CPF corresponding to the InterSystems IRIS configuration parameters and values specified in the merge file, see [Merge Updates](#). The second type is creating, deleting, or modifying InterSystems IRIS objects corresponding to the contents of the [\[Actions\]](#) section, see [Merge Actions](#).

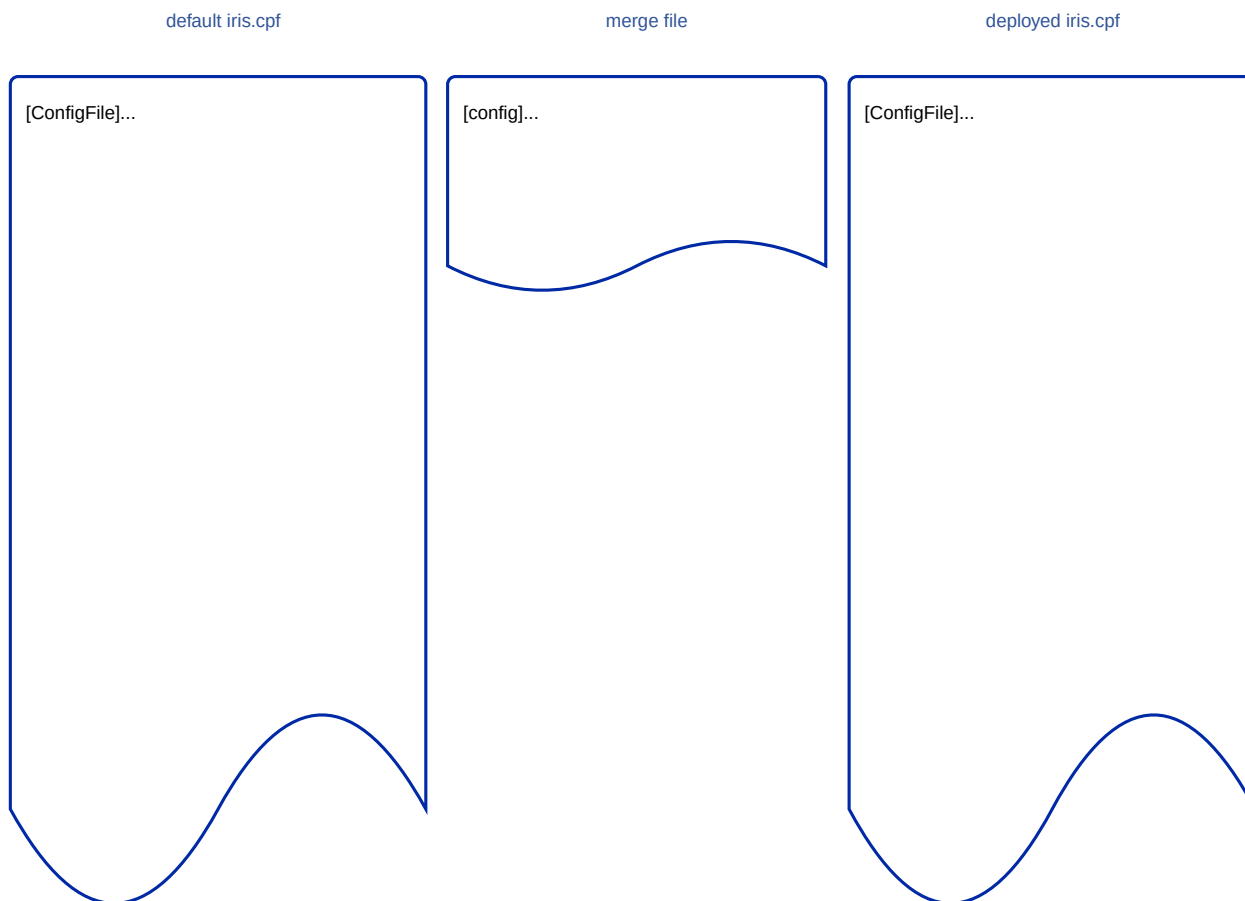
A merge file has the same syntax as a CPF (described in the [CPF Format](#) section), and can have any name and extension. The merge file may contain any of the parameters found within the CPF, though it is not necessary to include the values you are not changing.

Unlike the CPF, a merge file can contain duplicates of the same section and parameter. In this case, InterSystems IRIS prioritizes the value closer to the end of the file, which allows you to create a template merge file. For example, if you keep generally desired values at the top of the file and append instance-specific values at the bottom, InterSystems IRIS will prioritize the instance-specific values when reading the merge file.

1.4 Merge Updates

When a merge file is applied to an instance with configuration merge to update InterSystems IRIS configuration parameters, those settings are merged into the instance's CPF, replacing the values, as if you had edited the CPF and changed the values manually. If a parameter in the merge file is not present in the original CPF, it is simply added in the appropriate place.

For example, the data and compute nodes in a [sharded cluster](#) typically require with a database cache that is much larger than that generally configured for other purposes, and have more shared memory configured as well. To configure an instance to have a larger database cache and more shared memory when deployed, or to reconfigure an existing instance this way, you can apply a configuration merge file that includes the [globals](#) parameter (which specifies the size of the database cache) and the [gmheap](#) parameter (which specifies the amount of shared memory) with the desired values; these replace the default values in the CPF of the instance. The following illustrates the use of a merge file to update both the parameters when deploying an instance:

Figure 1–1: Merge File Updates Memory Settings During Deployment

For examples of using configuration merge to update configuration parameters, see [Useful Update Parameters in Automated Deployment](#).

1.5 Merge Actions

In addition to changing the values of configuration parameters, configuration merge can create, modify, and delete dozens of different InterSystems IRIS objects, such as namespaces and databases; users, roles, and resources; and mirrors and mirror members. This is done using the parameters in the [\[Actions\]](#) section, which is valid only in a merge file and does not appear in (and cannot be added to) an instance's CPF. For example, to add a global mapping to an instance, you would include in the merge file an [\[Actions\]](#) section containing the `CreateMapGlobal` parameter. The parameters in this section, which create, modify, and delete system objects, are sometimes called *action parameters*, to distinguish them from those that update parameter values, which are known as *update parameters*.

Action parameters can be used to manage objects on both new and existing instances. The operations specified by action parameters are idempotent, meaning that they are executed only if they would result in a change. More specifically:

- A Create action is not executed if the specified object exists.
- A Modify action is not executed if the specified object does not exist. (If the object exists but the action does not add to/modify the properties of the object, the action is executed but to no effect.)
- A Delete action is not executed if the specified object does not exist.

- A Config action is not executed if the object exists *and* the action does not add to/modify the properties of that object; if the object does not exist, *or* it exists and the action adds to/modifies its properties, the action is executed.

Action parameters are very useful in [deployment](#), for example to [configure several deployed instances as a mirror](#) using the ConfigMirror action and the MirrorSetName and MirrorDBName properties of the CreateDatabase action, enabling the new mirror to be fully operational, with mirrored databases in place, immediately following deployment. On the other hand, when used in [reconfiguring an existing instance](#) with the **iris merge** command, action parameters can enable you to immediately make changes that would otherwise require a [Management Portal](#) procedure or a class method call; notable examples are adding an arbiter to an existing mirror and adding a new database to an existing mirror using the MirrorSetName and MirrorDBName properties of the ModifyDatabase action, which must be done on the running primary instance.

The operations performed by action parameters are effected by calling methods of classes in the Config and Security packages, the SYS.Database and %SYSTEM.SQL.Security classes, as well as two SQL commands.

For examples of the use of action parameters, see [Useful Action Parameters in Automated Deployment](#).

For the list of available action parameters, see [\[Actions\] Parameter Reference](#).

1.6 Configuration Merge Uses

There are two primary uses for configuration merge:

- Configuring multi-instance topologies and stand-alone instances during deployment.
- Reconfiguring deployed multi-instance topologies and stand-alone instances.

For more information on using configuration merge during deployment, see [Configuration Merge in Deployment](#).

For more information on using configuration merge to reconfigure existing InterSystems IRIS instances, see [Reconfigure an Existing Instance Using Configuration Merge](#).

1.7 See Also

- [Best Practices for Configuration Merge](#)

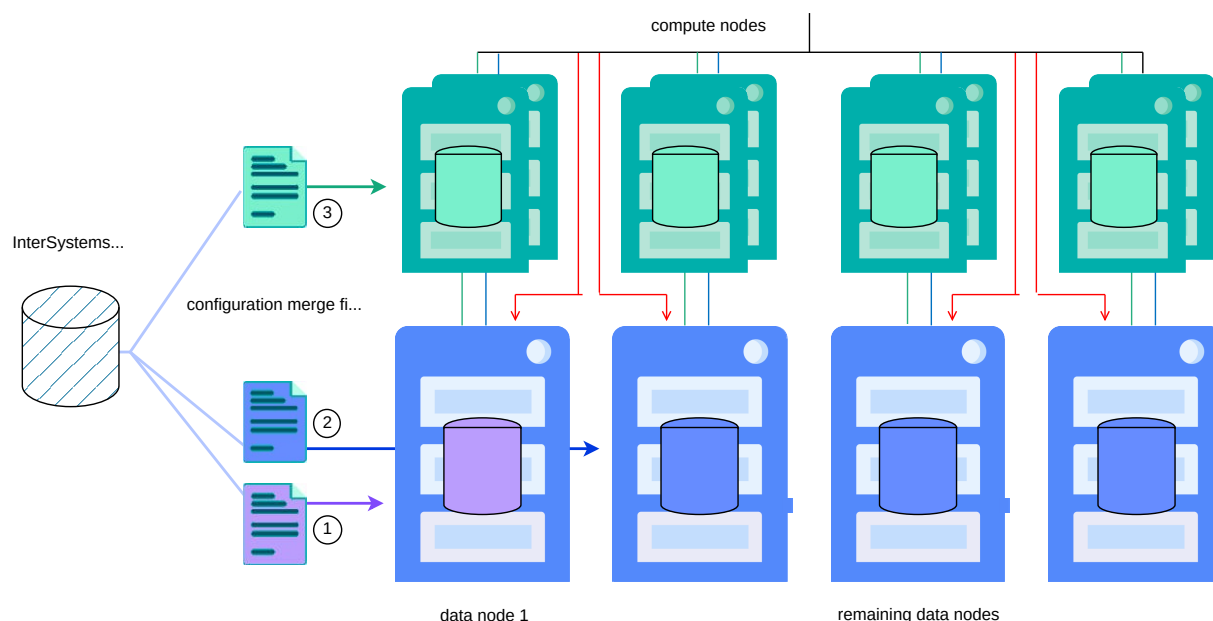
2

Configuration Merge in Deployment

This page describes the use case of configuration merge related to configuring multi-instance topologies and stand-alone instances during deployment. The use case of configuration merge related to reconfiguring an existing instance is described [Reconfigure an Existing Instance Using Configuration Merge](#).

Applying a configuration merge file during deployment lets you modify the default configurations of the deployed instance before it starts for the first time. This enables you to deploy containers with varying configurations from the same image, or install differently-configured instances from the same kit, directly into a multi-instance topology, rather than having to configure the instances into the desired topology after deployment. For example, in automated containerized deployment of a [sharded cluster with compute nodes](#), you can apply different merge files for data node 1, the remaining data nodes, and the compute nodes in that order, as shown in the following illustration; when all of the instances are up and running, so is the sharded cluster.

Figure 2-1: Automated Deployment of a Sharded Cluster Using Configuration Merge



In similar fashion, when deploying a [mirror](#), you would apply different configuration merge files for the primary, backup, and async members. Even a mirrored sharded cluster is easily deployed using this approach.

Activating configuration merge during deployment requires only that the location of the merge file be specified by the environment variable **ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE**, or by the field used for that purpose in the InterSystems Kubernetes Operator (IKO). For example, in manual or scripted deployment:

```
ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE=/home/user/mergefiles/cmf_090821.cpf
```

The specific manner in which you specify the merge file depends on the deployment mechanism you are using and whether the instance is containerized or noncontainerized.

- [Deploying an InterSystems IRIS container](#)
- [Installing InterSystems IRIS from a kit](#)
- [Deploying with the InterSystems Kubernetes Operator](#)

2.1 Deploying an InterSystems IRIS Container with a Merge File

When deploying an InterSystems IRIS container, the environment variable and merge file can be included in the following ways:

- Include them in the script or docker-compose.yml file you are using for deployment.

In the following sample deployment script, the merge file specified by **ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE**, as well as the license key, are staged on the external volume specified for durable %SYS by **ISC_DATA_DIRECTORY** so they are accessible inside the container.

```
#!/bin/bash
# script for quick demo and quick InterSystems IRIS image testing

# Definitions to toggle_____
container_image="intersystems/iris:latest-em"

# the docker run command

docker run -d
  -p 9091:1972
  -v /data/durable263:/durable
  -h iris
  --name iris
  --cap-add IPC_LOCK
  --env ISC_DATA_DIRECTORY=/durable/irisdata
  --env ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE=/durable/merge/CMF.cpf
  $container_image
  --key /durable/key/iris.key
```

Note: The image tags shown in this document are examples only. Please go to the [InterSystems Container Registry](#) (ICR) to browse current repositories and tags.

This sample docker-compose.yml file contains the same elements as the deployment script.

```
version: '3.2'

services:
  iris:
    image: intersystems/iris:latest-em
    command: --key /durable/key/iris.key
    hostname: iris

    ports:
      # 1972 is the superserver default port
      - "9091:1972"

    volumes:
      - /data/durable263:/durable

    environment:
      - ISC_DATA_DIRECTORY=/durable/irisdata
      - ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE=/durable/merge/CMF.cpf
```

- Include the merge file in the container image and the environment variable in the script or Docker compose file used in deployment.

When creating a custom InterSystems IRIS container image by starting with an InterSystems IRIS image from InterSystems and adding your own code and dependencies, you can execute the **iris merge** command in the Dockerfile to reconfigure the InterSystems IRIS instance contained in the image. For example, you can run the **iris merge** command with a merge file with [\[Actions\] parameters](#) to add namespaces and databases to the instance, which will then be present on the instance in every container created from your custom image. This method is explained and illustrated in [Creating InterSystems IRIS Images](#) in *Running InterSystems Products in Containers*.

If you want the containerized instances to continue to use the merge file you placed in the container, you can set **ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE** in your script or compose file to the location of this file. You can also run an additional, separate merge during deployment using a merge file positioned on the durable SYS volume, as illustrated above; if you plan to do this, add a command in the Dockerfile to remove the included merge file after it has been applied to the instance.

For examples of use cases for automated deployment using configuration merge, see [Useful Update parameters in automated deployment](#) and [Useful Action parameters in automated deployment](#).

2.2 Installing InterSystems IRIS from a Kit with a Merge File

To apply a merge file when installing InterSystems IRIS from a kit, manually or in a script, you must separate installation from startup, using the steps below.

On UNIX® or Linux system:

1. Install the instance without starting it by preceding the **irisinstall** or **irisinstall_silent** script with the **ISC_PACKAGE_STARTIRIS** parameter, as follows:

```
ISC_PACKAGE_INSTANCENAME="IRIS27" ISC_PACKAGE_STARTIRIS="N" /tmp/iriskit/irisinstall
```

2. Start the instance with the **iris start command**, preceding it with the **ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE** variable, as follows:

```
ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE=/tmp/iriskit/CMF/merge.cpf iris start IRIS27
```

On a Windows system:

1. Install and start the instance, for example:

```
IRIS-2023.2.0.227.0-win_x64.exe /instance IRIS27 INSTALLDIR=C:\InterSystems\IRIS27
```

2. When the instance is fully started, use the **iris merge** command (as described in [Reconfigure an existing instance using configuration merge](#)) to apply your merge file:

```
iris merge IRIS27 C:\InterSystems\IRIS27\merge.cpf
```

2.3 Using a Merge File when Deploying with the InterSystems Kubernetes Operator

[Kubernetes](#) is an open-source orchestration engine for automating deployment, scaling, and management of containerized workloads and services. The [InterSystems Kubernetes Operator](#) (IKO) extends the Kubernetes API with the *IrisCluster* custom resource, which can be deployed as an InterSystems IRIS sharded cluster, distributed cache cluster, or standalone instance (all optionally mirrored) on any Kubernetes platform. The IKO also adds InterSystems IRIS-specific cluster management capabilities to Kubernetes, enabling automation of tasks like adding nodes to a cluster, which you would otherwise have to do manually by interacting directly with the instances.

When deploying with the IKO, you use a Kubernetes [ConfigMap](#) to integrate one or more merge files into the deployment process. For detailed information, see [Create configuration files and provide a config map for them](#) in *Using the InterSystems Kubernetes Operator*.

2.4 See Also

- [Best Practices for Configuration Merge](#)
- [Useful Update Parameters in Automated Deployment](#)
- [Useful Action Parameters in Automated Deployment](#)

3

Reconfigure an Existing Instance Using Configuration Merge

This page describes the use case of configuration merge related to reconfiguring deployed multi-instance topologies and stand-alone instances. The use case of configuration merge related to deployment is described [Configuration Merge in Deployment](#).

By automating application of the same merge file to multiple running instances, you can simultaneously reconfigure all of those instances in the same way, applying the same set of configuration changes across your application or cluster. You can avoid updating settings that may have been customized on a per-instance basis and should not be modified simply by omitting these from the merge file, while including only those you know it is safe and desirable to change. A single automated program can of course apply different merge files to different groups of instances (such as different mirror member or cluster nodes types) as described in the previous section.

Applying all configuration changes with a merge file helps you streamline the process of making changes and maintain greater control over the instance's configuration. Rather than making numerous individual changes from the Terminal, on multiple pages of the [Management Portal](#), or by editing an instance's CPF manually, you can execute all the changes at once using identical syntax in a merge file. By keeping your merge files under version control, you ensure the availability of configuration history and the option of restoring a previous configuration.

3.1 The `iris merge` Command

The **`iris merge`** command, which can be used on both UNIX/Linux and Windows systems, applies a merge file to a running instance. For Windows operating systems, it requires OS authentication to execute. It is executed as follows:

```
iris merge instance [merge-file] [target-CPF]
```

where:

- *instance* is the name of the InterSystems IRIS instance.
- *merge-file* is the absolute or relative path to the merge file, including the filename. If *merge-file* is not specified, the value of the **`ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE`** environment variable is used, if it is set.
 - When performing a merge, you can provide either a single merge file or a comma-separated list of merge files. A comma-separated list of merge files is supported when performing any merge; either directly using the **`iris merge`** command or using the **`ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE`** environment variable with the **`iris start`** or **`iris-main`** commands. When performing a merge with a list of merge files, such as "`merge1.cpf, merge2.cpf`", the files will be

merged in order. If the list of merge files has empty elements, such as "merge1.cpf", "merge3.cpf", the empty elements are skipped.

- *target-CPF* is the absolute or relative path to the active CPF for instance *instance*, which is assumed to be named *iris.cpf*. If *target-CPF* is not specified, the defaults are as follows:
 - For noncontainerized instances, the *iris.cpf* file located in the directory specified by the **ISC_PACKAGE_INSTALLDIR** environment variable, if it is set. For most existing instances, this variable is not set, and you must explicitly specify the location of the target CPF.
 - For containerized instances, the *iris.cpf* file located in the directory specified by the **ISC_DATA_DIRECTORY** environment variable or, if it is not set (because durable %SYS is not in use), the **ISC_PACKAGE_INSTALLDIR** environment variable, which is always set in an InterSystems IRIS container.
 - If the environment variables **ISC_DATA_DIRECTORY** and **ISC_PACKAGE_INSTALLDIR** are not set and *target-CPF* is not specified, InterSystems IRIS checks for the location of *target-CPF* in the operating system registry.

No merge is performed if:

- The specified merge file is not present, or the *merge-file* argument is omitted and **ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE** does not exist.
- There is no CPF in the specified target location or all three of the following conditions: 1) the target location is not specified, 2) neither **ISC_DATA_DIRECTORY** or **ISC_PACKAGE_INSTALLDIR** exist and 3) the operating system registry does not have the path for *target-CPF* defined.

An exit code of 0 indicates a successful merge.

After entering the command, an InterSystems IRIS terminal prompts for you to supply a username and password (if OS authentication is not enabled). Only once authentication succeeds does the command complete execution. On an unsuccessful merge, the terminal indicates which line the merge failed on and you can press any key to close the window. On a successful merge, the success message displays for three (3) seconds before the window closes automatically.

Some changes merged into a CPF will not take effect immediately, but require a restart. For example, a change in the value of the [gmheap](#) parameter, which determines the size of the instance's shared memory heap, does not take effect until the instance is restarted. When your merge file contains one or more such parameters, you may need to apply the merge file as part of a restart, as in the following sample script excerpt:

```
# restart instance with the necessary parameters (all on one line)
sudo ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE=/net/merge_files/config_merge.cpf iris stop IRIS restart
```

On the other hand, applying a merge file with the **iris merge** command lets you immediately change settings that do not require a restart, including those that *cannot* be set during instance startup; an example, as noted in [Merge Actions](#), is adding a database to an existing mirror.

Important: When a container is deployed with configuration merge (as described in [Deploying an InterSystems IRIS container with a merge file](#)), the merge file specified by **ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE** (which is persistent in the container) is continuously monitored for updates as long as the container is running, with updates immediately merged by an **iris merge** command when they occur. This means that you can update the configuration of a containerized instance at any time by updating its merge file, making it easier to automate reconfiguration of containerized instances and clusters.

3.2 See Also

- [Best Practices for Configuration Merge](#)
- [Useful Update Parameters in Automated Deployment](#)
- [Useful Action Parameters in Automated Deployment](#)

4

Useful Update Parameters in Automated Deployment

The configuration merge feature can be used to update any combination of settings in an instance's CPF. Several automated deployment use cases that you may find useful and make good examples of the power of the configuration merge feature, along with the parameters involved, are discussed in this page. The following sections are related to [merge updates](#) to update parameters in the instances CPF and are those used to modify values in the deployed instance's CPF before the instance is started, thereby updating the default CPF in the deployment source (installation kit or container). Each parameter name provided is linked to its listing in the [Configuration Parameter File Reference](#) so you can easily review a parameter's purpose and details of its usage.

4.1 Change the Default Password

As described in [Authentication and Passwords](#) in *Running InterSystems Products in Containers*, you can use the [PasswordHash](#) setting in the [Startup] section to customize the default password of the predefined accounts on an instance at deployment, which eliminates the serious security risk entailed in allowing the default password of **SYS** to remain in effect. (The password of each predefined account should be individually changed following deployment.)

Table 4-1: Password Parameter

[Startup] Parameter	Specifies
PasswordHash	Default password for the predefined user accounts based on a cryptographic hash of the value and its salt

Note: The [Actions]/CreateUser parameter also takes a PasswordHash argument that is equivalent to the parameter (see [\[Actions\] Parameter Reference](#)).

4.2 Configure and Allocate Memory

There are a number of parameters affecting an InterSystems IRIS instance's memory usage, the optimal value of which can depend on the physical memory available, the instance's role within the cluster, the workload involved, and performance requirements.

For example, the optimal size of an instance's database cache, which can be specified using the [globals](#) parameter, can vary greatly depend on the instance's role; as noted above, sharded cluster data nodes typically require a relatively large cache. But even within that role, the optimal size depends on the size of the cluster's sharded data set, and the implemented size may be smaller than optimal due to resource constraints. (For more information, see [Planning an InterSystems IRIS Sharded Cluster](#) in the *Scalability Guide*.) Further, because the database cache should be carefully sized in general, the default database cache setting (the value of `globals` in the `iris.cpf` file provided in the container) is intentionally unsuitable for any production environment, regardless of the instance's role.

Some of the memory usage settings in the `[Config]` section of the CPF that you might want to update as part of deployment are listed in the following table:

Table 4–2: Memory Parameters

[Config] Parameter	Specifies
bbsiz	Maximum process private memory per process
globals	Shared memory allocated to the database cache (not from shared memory heap)
routines	Shared memory allocated to the routine cache (not from shared memory heap)
gmheap	Shared memory configured as the shared memory heap
jrnbufs	Shared memory allocated to journal buffers from the shared memory heap
locksiz	Maximum shared memory allocated to locks from the shared memory heap

For more detail on these and other memory-related parameters, see [System Resource Planning and Management](#), [Memory and Startup Settings](#), [Configuring Journal Settings](#), and [Monitoring Locks](#).

4.3 Configure SQL and SQL Shell Options and Map SQL Datatypes

You can specify the SQL and SQL Shell settings for instances you are deploying by merging one or more of the parameters in the `[SQL]` section of the CPF. In the [Management Portal](#) these settings can be reviewed and modified on the **SQL** page (**System Administration > Configuration > SQL and Object Settings > SQL**). You can map SQL system data types and SQL user data types to their InterSystems SQL equivalents on deployed instances using the [\[SqlSysDatatypes\]](#) and [\[SqlUserDatatypes\]](#) sections of the CPF, respectively. For more detail on SQL Shell setting and datatype mapping, see [Configuring the SQL Shell](#) and [Data Types \(SQL\)](#), respectively.

4.4 Update Parameter Example

The following sample CPF merge file includes some of the update parameters discussed in the preceding sections. The [SystemMode](#) parameter specifies a label that is displayed at the top of the Management Portal.

```
[Startup]
SystemMode=TEST
PasswordHash=FBFE8593AEFA510C27FD184738D6E865A441DE98,u40cm4qh

[config]
bbsiz=-1
globals=0,0,900,0,0,0
routines=64
gmheap=256000
jrnbufs=96
locksiz=1179648

[SQL]
DefaultSchema=user
TimePrecision=6

[SqlSysDatatypes]
TIMESTAMP=%Library.PosixTime
```

4.5 See Also

- [Configuration Merge in Deployment](#)
- [Reconfigure an Existing Instance Using Configuration Merge](#)
- [Useful Action Parameters in Automated Deployment](#)

5

Useful Action Parameters in Automated Deployment

The configuration merge feature can be used to execute certain operations on the instance as specified in the [\[Actions\]](#) section. Several automated deployment use cases that you may find useful and make good examples of the power of the configuration merge feature, along with the parameters involved, are discussed in this page.

The sections related to creating, modifying, or deleting InterSystems IRIS objects are among those that can be included in the [\[Actions\]](#) section to create, modify, or delete different types of objects on an instance as part deployment (or reconfiguration), including databases, namespaces, and mappings; users, roles, and resources; and many more. The use of action parameters (often simply called *actions*) is described in [merge actions](#), the comprehensive list of actions is available in [\[Actions\] Parameter Reference](#)

5.1 Create, Modify, and Delete Security Objects

Include the operations described in the following table in the [\[Actions\]](#) section to create and modify security objects as part of deployment or reconfiguration.

Table 5–1: Sample Security Object Creation Parameters

[Actions] Parameter	Specifies
CreateUser	The name and properties of the user account to be created. You can also use ModifyUser and DeleteUser.
CreateRole	The name and properties of the role to be created. You can also use ModifyRole and DeleteRole.
CreateResource	The name and properties of the resource to be created. You can also use ModifyResource and DeleteResource.
GrantAdminPrivilege, GrantPrivilege	The user account to grant SQL admin privileges and SQL privileges to, the privileges to be granted, and the namespace to grant them in. You can also use RevokeAdminPrivilege and RevokePrivilege.
ModifyService	The service to enable or disable.
CreateApplication	The name and properties of the application to be created. You can also use ModifyApplication and DeleteApplication.
CreateSSLConfig	The name, location, and properties of the TLS/SSL configuration to be created. You can also use ModifySSLConfig and DeleteSSLConfig.
CreateLDAPConfig	The name and properties of the LDAP configuration to be created. You can also use ModifyLDAPConfig and DeleteLDAPConfig.
CreateEvent	The name, properties and status of the system audit event to be created. You can also use ModifyEvent and DeleteEvent.

To illustrate the use of action parameters with security objects, suppose you wanted to add to deployed instances a predefined account for a SQL administrator user who:

- Has SQL access through the %Service_Bindings service (%SQL role).
- Can read from or write to the **USER** database (%DB_USER role).
- Can create and drop tables, views, procedures, functions, methods, queries, and triggers (%DB_OBJECT_DEFINITION privilege) and use the BUILD INDEX command (%BUILD_INDEX privilege) in the **USER** namespace.

To do this, you could use the CreateUser parameter to create the user account with password and assign it the needed roles, and the GrantAdminPrivilege parameter to grant it the needed SQL privileges, as follows:

[Actions]

```
CreateUser:Name=SQLAdmin,
PasswordHash="cec6638a357e7586fddfb15c0e7dd5719a1964e774cd37466fb0c49c05,
323cb89148c887166dd2be61c107710539af2c01b43f07dccc8d030ac2c1a8cf7c5ace4a00d57e3780f,10000,SHA512",
Roles="%SQL,%DB_USER"
```

```
GrantAdminPrivilege:Grantee=SQLAdmin,Namespace=USER,AdminPriv="%DB_OBJECT_DEFINITION,%BUILD_INDEX"
```

For information about the operations performed by these action parameters and the values of their properties, see [Authentication and Passwords](#), [About InterSystems Authorization](#), and [SQL Users, Roles, and Privileges](#).

5.1.1 Security Macros

InterSystems IRIS supports a set of [macros](#) that you can use in the [Actions] section of the configuration merge file (CMF). These macros relate to the AuthEnabled property for the Security.Applications, Security.Services, Security.System,

and Security.Users classes as well as the LDAPFlags property in the Security.LDAPConfigs class. Supported macros are listed below.

AuthEnabled macros:

- AuthK5CCache — Enables Kerberos credential cache authentication.
- AuthK5Prompt — Enables Kerberos password prompt authentication.
- AuthK5API — Enables Kerberos username and password authentication.
- AuthK5KeyTab — Enables Kerberos keytab file authentication.
- AuthOS — Enables operating system authentication.
- AuthPassword — Enables password authentication.
- AuthUnauthenticated — Enables unauthenticated access.
- AuthKB — Enables Kerberos base connection security level.
- AuthKBEncryption — Enables Kerberos with Encryption connection security level.
- AuthKBIntegrity — Enables Kerberos with Packet Integrity connection security level.
- AuthLDAP — Enables LDAP authentication.
- AuthLDAPCache — Enables LDAP cached credentials for LDAP authentication.
- AuthDelegated — Enables delegated authentication.
- AuthLoginToken — Enables creation of Login Cookies.
- AuthKerberosDelegated — Enables using Kerberos for authentication then uses delegated authorization.
- AuthOSDelegated — Enables using the operating system to authenticate the user then uses delegated authorization.
- AuthOSLDAP — Enables Operating Systems authentication then LDAP authorization.
- AuthTwoFactorSMS — Enables SMS two factor authentication for a user.
- AuthTwoFactorPW — Enables one-time password two factor authentication for a user.
- AuthAlwaysTryDelegated — Enables using delegated authentication code for users authenticating with instance authentication.
- AuthMutualTLS — Enables mutual TLS when modifying **%Service_WebGateway**.

LDAPFlags macros:

- LDAPActiveDirectory — Indicates that the LDAP server is a Windows Active Directory server.
- LDAPTLSConnection — Enables use of TLS for LDAP sessions.
- LDAPAllowISCLDAPCONFIGURATION — Enables use of the *ISC_LDAP_CONFIGURATION* environment variable if using OS-based LDAP and multiple domains to determine which LDAP configuration to use for authentication.
- LDAPUseGroups — Enables using LDAP groups for Roles/Routine/Namespace.
- LDAPUseNestedGroups — Enables searching to return all of a user's nested LDAP groups.
- LDAPUniversalGroups — Enables searches using attributes on the LDAP server that are relevant for all InterSystems IRIS instances.
- LDAPEnabled — Enables the LDAP configuration.
- LDAPKerberosOnly — Enables use of Kerberos only for an LDAP configuration.

The following example shows how you could do this with a merge file:

```
[Actions]
CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPA,Description="APPA database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPA,Directory=/database-path/APPA,ResourceName=%DB_APPA
ModifyNamespace:Name=APPA,Globals=APPA,Interop=1

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPB,Description="APPB database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPB,Directory=/database-path/APPB,ResourceName=%DB_APPB
CreateNamespace:Name=APPB,Globals=APPB,Interop=1
```

Suppose that at a later point you wanted to add mappings of globals and routines in database **APPA** to namespace **APPB**. You could do this with a merge file like the following:

```
[Actions]
CreateMapGlobal:Name="global-name(1):(101)",Namespace=APPB,Database=APPA
CreateMapRoutine:Namespace=APPB,Name=routine-spec,Database=APPA
```

For information about the operations performed by these action parameters and the values of their properties, see [Create/Modify a Namespace](#), [Create a Local Database](#), and [Add Global, Routine, and Package Mapping to a Namespace](#).

5.3 Deploy a Distributed Cache Cluster

With a few simple changes to the merge file example in the previous section, you can create merge files to deploy a distributed cache cluster.

For information about the operations performed by these action parameters in the following sections and the values of their properties, see [Remote Databases](#) and [Deploying a Distributed Cache Cluster](#).

5.3.1 Deploy the Data Server

The merge file below would be used to deploy the nonmirrored data server. In addition to creating the application databases and their associated resources and namespaces, it does the following:

- Enables the ECP service with an action parameter.
- Uses an update parameter to set the maximum number of concurrent application server connections the data server can accept to 16.

Differences from the previous sample merge file are emphasized.

```
# nonmirrored data server merge file

[Config]
MaxServerConn=16

[Actions]
ModifyService:Name=%service_ecp,Enabled=1

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPA,Description="APPA database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPA,Directory=/database-path/APPA,ResourceName=%DB_APPA
CreateNamespace:Name=APPA,Globals=APPA

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPB,Description="APPB database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPB,Directory=/database-path/APPB,ResourceName=%DB_APPB
CreateNamespace:Name=APPB,Globals=APPB
```

5.3.2 Deploy the Application Servers

This merge file, which would be used to deploy all of the application servers, does the following:

- Adds the data server as a remote server with an update parameter
- Modifies the `CreateDatabase` actions above by adding the `Server` and `LogicalOnly` properties and updating the `Directory` argument to point to existing databases on the remote server, rather than a local directory in which to create a local database.

Differences from the sample merge file in the previous section are emphasized.

```
# app servers merge file

[ECPServers]

dataAB=dataserver-address,port,0

[Actions]

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPA,Description="APPA database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPA,Server=dataAB,Directory=/database-path-on-dataserver-dataAB/APPA,ResourceName=%DB_APPA,
    LogicalOnly=1,
CreateNamespace:Name=APPDBA,Globals=APPA

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPB,Description="APPB database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPB,Server=dataAB,Directory=/database-path-on-dataserver-dataAB/APPB,ResourceName=%DB_APPB,
    LogicalOnly=1
CreateNamespace:Name=APPB,Globals=APPB
```

5.3.3 Deploy the Application Servers with Mirrored Data Server

If you are deploying an application server who's data server is mirrored, the merge file must be altered. This merge file alters the application server merge file previously shown only by changing the `0` at the end of the remote server definition action in `[ECPServers]` to `1`, as emphasized, to indicate that the remote server is a mirror, which allows application connections to transparently switch to the new primary after failover.

```
# app servers merge file

[ECPServers]

dataAB=dataserver-address,port,1

[Actions]

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPA,Description="APPA database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPA,Directory=/database-path-on-dataserver-dataAB/APPA,ResourceName=%DB_APPA,
    Server=dataAB,LogicalOnly=1
CreateNamespace:Name=APPDBA,Globals=APPA

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPB,Description="APPB database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPB,Directory=/database-path-on-dataserver-dataAB/APPB/,ResourceName=%DB_APPB,
    Server=dataAB,LogicalOnly=1
CreateNamespace:Name=APPB,Globals=APPB
```

5.4 Mirror the Cluster's Data Server

To deploy one or more InterSystems IRIS mirrors, you can use separate configuration merge files, each containing the [ConfigMirror](#) action parameter, for the different mirror roles, sequentially deploying the first failover member(s), then the second failover member(s), then DR async members, then any reporting async members if desired.

You can also deploy using a single merge file and hostname matching, which determines which member to deploy on each of a set of hosts the names of which match the required pattern.

This section provides examples of each approach, see [ConfigMirror](#) for information on the available properties for the `ConfigMirror` action parameter.

For detailed information about mirror configuration, see [Mirroring Architecture and Planning](#) and [Creating a Mirror](#). Be sure to read [Mirroring with InterSystems IRIS Containers](#) before planning containerized deployment of mirrors, or reconfiguring existing containerized instances into mirrors. Among other important considerations, you must ensure that the `ISCAgent` starts whenever the container for a failover or DR async mirror member starts.

5.5 Deploy the Mirror Using Separate Merge Files

In planning deployment using separate merge files it is important to bear in mind that the instance configured as the mirror primary must be running before other members can be added, so you must ensure that this instance is deployed and successfully started before other instances are deployed as the remaining members.

Deploy the Data Server Mirror Members

The following merge files deploy the distributed cache cluster's data server as a mirror with a DR async member by doing the following:

- Including the `ConfigMirror` action parameter to create the mirror and add members.
- On the primary, adding the created databases to the mirror (they will be automatically added on the other members).

Differences from the corresponding merge file in the previous section are emphasized.

```
# mirrored data server primary merge file
```

```
[Config]
MaxServerConn=16
```

```
[Actions]
```

```
ModifyService:Name=%service_ecp,Enabled=1
```

```
ConfigMirror:Name=CLUSTERAB,SSLDir=ssl-directory-path,
Member=primary,Primary=localhost,ArbiterURL=address:port
```

```
CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPA,Description="APPA database"
```

```
CreateDatabase:Name=APPA,Directory=/ddatabase-path/APPA,ResourceName=%DB_APPA,
```

```
MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPA
```

```
CreateNamespace:Name=APPA,Globals=APPA
```

```
CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPB,Description="APPB database"
```

```
CreateDatabase:Name=APPB,Directory=/ddatabase-path/APPB,ResourceName=%DB_APPB,
```

```
MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPB
```

```
CreateNamespace:Name=APPB,Globals=APPB
```

```
# mirrored data server merge file to add backup, DR async, read-only reporting async, or read-write
reporting async;
# for ConfigMirror Member argument enter either =backup, =drasync, =rorasync, or =rwrasync as appropriate
```

```
[Config]
MaxServerConn=16
```

```
[Actions]
```

```
ModifyService:Name=%service_ecp,Enabled=1
```

```
ConfigMirror:Name=CLUSTERAB,SSLDir=ssl-directory-path,
Member=backup|drasync|rorasync|rwrasync,Primary=primary-address:,ArbiterURL=address:port
```

```
CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPA,Description="APPA database"
```

```
CreateDatabase:Name=APPA,Directory=/ddatabase-path/APPA,ResourceName=%DB_APPA,
```

```
MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPA
```

```
CreateNamespace:Name=APPA,Globals=APPA
```

```
CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPB,Description="APPB database"
```

```
CreateDatabase:Name=APPB,Directory=/ddatabase-path/APPB,ResourceName=%DB_APPB,
```

```
MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPB
```

```
CreateNamespace:Name=APPB,Globals=APPB
```

Note: To add existing databases to the mirror created by the `ConfigMirror` action instead of creating empty ones, you could use the `LogicalOnly` parameter of the `CreateDatabase` action, where the `Name` and `Directory` parameters specify an existing database, this is shown in the modified excerpt from either section (primary or backup/DR async) of the previous example:

```
ConfigMirror:Name=CLUSTERAB,SSLDDir=ssl-directory-path,
  Member=backup|drasync,Primary=primary-address:,ArbiterURL=address:port

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPA,Description="APPA database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPA,Directory=ddatabase-path/APPA,ResourceName=%DB_APPA,
  MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPA,LogicalOnly=1
CreateNamespace:Name=APPA,Globals=APPA

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPB,Description="APPB database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPB,Directory=ddatabase-path/APPB,ResourceName=%DB_APPB,
  MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPB,LogicalOnly=1
CreateNamespace:Name=APPB,Globals=APPB
```

To copy existing databases (to a new location before being added) to the mirror created by the `ConfigMirror` action instead of creating empty ones, you could use the `Seed` parameter of the `CreateDatabase` action to specify the path names of the databases to copy, as shown in this modified excerpt from either section (primary or backup/DR async) of the previous example:

```
ConfigMirror:Name=CLUSTERAB,SSLDDir=ssl-directory-path,
  Member=backup|drasync,Primary=primary-address:,ArbiterURL=address:port

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPA,Description="APPA database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPA,Directory=ddatabase-path/APPA,ResourceName=%DB_APPA,
  MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPA,Seed=/mnt/databases/DB1
CreateNamespace:Name=APPA,Globals=APPA

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPB,Description="APPB database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPB,Directory=ddatabase-path/APPB,ResourceName=%DB_APPB,
  MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPB,Seed=/mnt/databases/DB2
CreateNamespace:Name=APPB,Globals=APPB
```

5.6 Deploy the Mirror Using Hostname Matching

You can automatically deploy one or more mirrors from a single merge file if the deployment hosts have names ending in *-number* (or, as a regular expression, `*-[0-9]+$`), for example `iris-000`, `iris-001`, `iris-002` ..., or in *-number-number*, for example `iris-0-0`, `iris-0-1`, `iris-1-0`, `iris-1-1` You do this by

- Setting the `Map` argument (not used with the separate merge file approach) to the pattern you want (it is `primary`, `backup` by default, but can also contain up to 14 DR async members as in `primary, backup, drasync, ...`)
- Setting the `Member` and `Primary` arguments to `auto`.

For example, if you used the following `ConfigMirror` action parameter, mirror members would be deployed on appropriately named hosts as shown in the table after the example:

```
ConfigMirror:Name=AUTOMIRROR,SSLDDir=ssl-directory-path,
  Map="primary, backup, drasync",
  Member=auto,Primary=auto,ArbiterURL=address:port
```

Table 5–3: Mirror Deployment by Hostname

Single-number hostnames	Double-number hostnames	Mirror member role
mirror-000	mirror-0-0	primary
mirror-001	mirror-0-1	backup
mirror-002	mirror-0-2	DR async
mirror-003	mirror-1-0	primary
mirror-004	mirror-1-1	backup
mirror-005	mirror-1-2	DR async

To allow multiple independent InterSystems IRIS clusters to communicate without mirror member name collisions, you can offset the hostnames of one of the clusters by a number to prevent overlap using the optional `Ordinal` property. For example, if `Ordinal` is set to 100, then the corresponding hostnames are `iris-100`, `iris-101`, `iris-102` ...

As another example, if you used the following `ConfigMirror` action parameter, mirror members would be deployed on appropriately named hosts as shown in the table after the example:

```
ConfigMirror:Name=AUTOMIRROR,SSLDir=ssl-directory-path,
  Map="primary,backup,drasync",
  Member=auto,Primary=auto,ArbiterURL=address:port
  Ordinal=100
```

Table 5–4: Mirror Deployment by Hostname with Ordinal

Single-number hostnames	Double-number hostnames	Mirror member role
mirror-100	mirror-0-100	primary
mirror-101	mirror-0-101	backup
mirror-102	mirror-0-102	DR async
mirror-103	mirror-1-100	primary
mirror-104	mirror-1-101	backup
mirror-105	mirror-1-102	DR async

Deploy Mirror Members by Hostname

Incorporating a `ConfigMirror` action like the one above, you could use hostname matching to deploy a three-member mirrored data server using the following single merge file on three sequentially named hosts such as `iris-001`, `iris-002`, and `iris-003` rather than three merge files as shown in the previous section.

```
# mirrored data server using single merge file and hostname mapping

[Config]
MaxServerConn=16

[Actions]

ModifyService:Name=%service_ecp,Enabled=1

ConfigMirror:Name=CLUSTERAB,SSLDDir=ssl-directory-path,
  Map="primary,backup,drasync",Member=auto,
  Primary=auto,ArbiterURL=address:port
CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPA,Description="APPA database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPA,Directory=/ddatabase-path/APPA,ResourceName=%DB_APPA,
  MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPA
CreateNamespace:Name=APPA,Globals=APPA

CreateResource:Name=%DB_APPB,Description="APPB database"
CreateDatabase:Name=APPB,Directory=/ddatabase-path/APPB,ResourceName=%DB_APPB,
  MirrorSetName=CLUSTERAB,MirrorDBName=APPB
CreateNamespace:Name=APPB,Globals=APPB
```

5.7 See Also

- [Configuration Merge in Deployment](#)
- [Reconfigure an Existing Instance Using Configuration Merge](#)
- [Useful Update Parameters in Automated Deployment](#)

6

Best Practices for Configuration Merge

This page describes some of the best practices related to using the configuration merge feature. For more information on the configuration merge feature, see [Introduction to Configuration Merge](#).

Source control your merge files

InterSystems recommends keeping the merge files involved in any application of the configuration merge feature under version control. Version control provides a record of all configuration changes, from deployment forward, over the life of an instance or a multi-instance topology. It also allows you to restore a previous configuration and easily share merge files with other users. You can also easily update your automated deployment or reconfiguration process, which uses configuration merge, by updating the merge files applied with the latest version of the merge file. You could also require users to get the latest version of the appropriate merge file before deploying or reconfiguring an instance, even in the case of individual instances used for purposes such as development or testing. This would ensure all deployments and reconfigured instances have identical configurations which match a central specification, regardless of if it is a single instance or multiple instances.

Once you use configuration merge to deploy or reconfigure, use it for all configuration changes

If you use configuration merge, the strongly recommended best practice is to confine all configuration changes to this method — even when this means, for example, using **iris merge** to change just one or two parameters on one instance. If changes to the instance's CPF are not made with configuration merge, assuming you version and store the merge files, the changes won't be source controlled, and a record of those changes will not exist. This poses a risk of configuration merge overwriting these changes made by other means, and with no record of the changes, they won't be recovered. In the case of a single instance, for example, a lone development instance, this risk may be acceptable; where a record of configuration changes to roll back to in the event of a problem is not necessarily needed. However, in the case of many instances or in a production environment, this risk is not acceptable. Therefore, if you confine all configuration changes to configuration merge, you can avoid the possibility and risk of configuration merge overwriting changes made by other means.

In a container, the potential of configuration merge overwriting changes made by other means is very great due to the continuous monitoring and merging of the merge file identified by the **ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE** variable, as described in [The iris merge Command](#). This allows you to use configuration merge and a central repository of merge files to apply further changes to existing instances simply by updating their merge files at any time. However, if the configuration parameters included in the merge file have been changed on the instance in the container by another method since deployment, the update merge can erase those changes, of which there may not be any record. Confining all configuration changes to configuration merge avoids this. (If the merge file does not exist, startup displays an error message and continues.)

How to avoid configuration overwrites in a container if not only using configuration merge

If you do not confine changes to configuration merge, you can avoid the possibility of configuration merge making unwanted changes by including in your automation (using, for example, the **iris-main --after** option) the scripting of either or both of the following after instance startup:

- The deletion of the **ISC_CPF_MERGE_FILE** environment variable in each deployed container. (If the merge file does not exist, startup displays an error message and continues.)
- The replacement of the merge file in each container with an empty file.